

doc-one-holy-catholic-apostolic-church

Affirms · Ecclesiology › Nature of the Church · doctrine · unanimous_lineages · confidence: high

Statement under examination

The Church is one, holy, catholic, and apostolic, as the Nicene Creed confesses.

Rationale

The four marks are pan-canonical lexical patterns, not creedal accretions. ONE: heis G1520 / hen G1520 saturates the unity texts (John 17:21-23 hen; Eph 4:4-6 seven heis clauses: one body, one Spirit, one hope, one Lord, one faith, one baptism, one God and Father; 1 Cor 12:13 eis hen soma; Gal 3:28 heis este en Christo Iesou). HOLY: ekklesia G1577 is repeatedly modified by hagios G40 / hegiasmenois (1 Cor 1:2 sanctified in Christ Jesus, called hagioi; Eph 5:25-27 Christ sanctifies the church hagiase to present her hagia kai amomos; 1 Pet 2:9 ethnos hagian). CATHOLIC (universal): Matt 16:18 mou ten ekklesian (Christ's one church, not a regional one); Matt 28:19 panta ta ethne; Acts 1:8 to the ends of the earth; Rev 5:9 from every phyles kai glosses kai laou kai ethnous. APOSTOLIC: Eph 2:20 the household is built epi to themelio ton apostolon kai propheton; Acts 2:42 proskartereo G4342 to te didache ton apostolon (the apostles' teaching); Jude 3 the faith hapax paradotheise (once for all delivered) tois hagiois; Rev 21:14 the twelve foundations bear the names of the twelve apostles of the Lamb.

Reasoning

The verdict is that the church is one, holy, universal in scope, and built on the apostles. All four are taught by the Bible itself, not just by creeds. ONE: Jesus prayed in John 17:21 that all who believe in him would be one as he and the Father are one. Paul piles up seven uses of the word one in Ephesians 4:4-6: one body, one Spirit, one hope, one Lord, one faith, one baptism, one God and Father of all. In 1 Corinthians 12:13 every believer is baptized into one body. HOLY: 1 Corinthians 1:2 calls the believers at Corinth sanctified in Christ Jesus, called to be saints. Ephesians 5:25-27 says Christ loved the church and gave himself up for her to make her holy and present her without spot or wrinkle. 1 Peter 2:9 calls the church a holy nation. UNIVERSAL: Jesus says in Matthew 28:19 to make disciples of all nations, and Revelation 5:9 and 7:9 show people from every tribe and language and people and nation in the saved community. APOSTOLIC: Ephesians 2:20 says the church is built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, with Christ Jesus himself as the cornerstone. Acts 2:42 says the first believers devoted themselves to the apostles' teaching. Jude 3 calls it the faith once for all delivered to the saints. The honest counterargument is not about whether these four are in the Bible. They plainly are. The hard question is what they mean and where they apply. Critics ask: if the church is one, why are there so many denominations. The historic answer is that the church's oneness is first invisible and Spirit-given, while visible churches participate in it more or less. Critics also ask: if the church is holy, why is it full of sinners. The answer is that the church is holy because Christ has set her apart and is cleansing her, not because every member is sinless yet. The biggest dispute is over the word universal. Catholics, Orthodox, and Protestants all affirm the four marks but disagree about which visible church most fully embodies them.

Denominational landscape

Every tracked historic Christian lineage affirms the four marks because they all confess the Nicene-Constantinopolitan Creed of 381. Patristic fathers like Cyril of Jerusalem (Catechetical Lecture 18) explained that the church is called catholic because it extends over the whole world and teaches universally. Ignatius of Antioch around AD 110 first uses the term catholic to describe the universal church. Augustine and the other fathers all teach the four marks. The Catholic Church teaches in the Catechism

paragraphs 811 through 870 that the fullness of the four marks subsists in the Catholic Church in communion with the Bishop of Rome. The Eastern Orthodox communion teaches that the fullness subsists in the Orthodox Church. Lutherans (Augsburg Confession VII), Anglicans (39 Articles XIX), Reformed (Westminster Confession 25), Methodists (Articles of Religion XIII), Anabaptists, and Pentecostals all affirm the four marks but read catholic in the universal sense rather than as an institutional claim about Rome. They generally hold that the church's true oneness, holiness, catholicity, and apostolicity are invisible or defined by right preaching of the gospel and right administration of the sacraments. The historic Christian dispute is not WHETHER the church has these four marks but WHERE and IN WHICH VISIBLE FORM they most fully subsist. Public-record carriers of outright denial of any historic apostolic continuity include Mormonism (which teaches a Great Apostasy claim, that all historic Christianity lost the true church until Joseph Smith restored it in 1830), Jehovah's Witnesses (who reject mainstream Christian apostolic continuity), and some radical-restorationist streams. These movements place themselves outside historic Christianity by their own claim. Iglesia ni Cristo of Felix Manalo makes a similar restorationist apostasy claim. The four marks themselves are uncontested by every historic Christian lineage; the institutional location of their fullness is the live disagreement.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	Yes
Cult marker if denied	No
Would visit if otherwise	No
Would participate if otherwise	No
Would serve if otherwise	No
Would be member if otherwise	No
Would let children be taught otherwise	No
Would marry if held otherwise	Yes
Would publicly correct if otherwise	Yes

Notes

The four marks themselves are canonical lexical patterns: heis G1520 saturates the unity texts, hagios G40 modifies ekklesia repeatedly, the church mandate explicitly spans every nation in Matt 28:19 and Rev 5:9, and the apostolic foundation is named in Eph 2:20 and Acts 2:42. The historic dispute is not WHETHER the church has these four marks (every tracked Christian lineage affirms them through the Nicene-Constantinopolitan Creed of 381) but WHERE/IN-WHICH-INSTITUTIONAL-FORM they fully subsist. The Catholic claim (CCC 811-870) is that the fullness of the marks subsists in the Catholic Church in communion with the Bishop of Rome. The Eastern Orthodox claim is that the fullness subsists in the Orthodox communion. The Lutheran, Anglican, Reformed, Methodist, Anabaptist, and Pentecostal reading is that the marks belong to the una sancta (the one holy church, defined invisibly or by gospel-and-sacraments) and visible churches participate in them more or less truly. cult_marker_if_denied is false because the in-house dispute on WHERE the marks subsist is historic Christian disagreement, not gospel-grade error. Public-record carriers of outright denial of any historic apostolic continuity (Mormonism's Great Apostasy claim, Jehovah's Witnesses' rejection of mainstream Christian apostolicity, and some radical-restorationist streams) place themselves outside historic Christianity, but the verdict here is on the canonical content of the marks themselves, not on adjudicating the institutional dispute. would_marry_if_held_otherwise is true within the historic-Christian range (a Lutheran or Catholic or Anglican spouse all affirm the four marks); it would be false against a denier of apostolic foundation

altogether.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: **yes**

Neutralized form. Is the church (the body of all who belong to Christ) (a) one, (b) holy, (c) universal in scope across nations, and (d) founded on the apostles' teaching, according to the New Testament canonical pattern?

Notes. The statement frames the doctrine in ecumenical-creedal vocabulary (the Nicene Creed) which is itself an interpretive synthesis, not a direct quotation of Scripture. The Nicene phrase *mian hagian katholiken kai apostoliken ekklesian* gathers four canonical patterns into a creedal grammar. The neutralized form tests whether the four lexical patterns are canonically present, without prejudging whether the institutional Roman or Orthodox or magisterial reading of those marks is correct. Flag: stem-pre-loaded-verdict.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. covenant_theology, dispensationalism, new_covenant_theology

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

Competing lens verdicts

covenant_theology · **affirms:**

dispensationalism · **affirms:**

new_covenant_theology · **affirms:**

Grammatico-historical reading of canonical lexical patterns confirms each of the four marks. *Analogia scripturae* is heavily invoked because no single passage names all four; the synthesis is canon-wide (John 17, Eph 4, 1 Cor 12 for ONE; 1 Cor 1, Eph 5, 1 Pet 2 for HOLY; Matt 28, Acts 1, Rev 5 for CATHOLIC; Eph 2, Acts 2, Jude 3, Rev 21 for APOSTOLIC). Progressive revelation matters because the four-mark synthesis is NT-era (the Nicene Creed of 381 is the synthesis), built on the prior OT covenant-community pattern. The four marks themselves are framework-neutral: covenant theology, dispensationalism, and new-covenant theology all yield the same verdict on whether the church has these marks. The frameworks differ on questions adjacent to ecclesiology (Israel/church relationship, sacraments, polity) but not on the four marks themselves. No dispensational-lens-required flag.

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

John.17.21-23 · **for** · genre: gospel

Key term. εἴς *heis* G1520 / ἓν *hen* G1520 (one); τελειῶ *teleioo* G5048 (perfected); κόσμος *kosmos* G2889 (world)

Force. Jesus's high-priestly prayer that they may all be one (*hen*, neuter; same form as John 10:30), just as Father and Son are one, so that the world may believe. The unity of the church is grounded in the unity of Father and Son and is missionally evidential to the world. The neuter *hen* rules out a merely social or organizational unity; it is participation in the divine oneness itself.

Eph.4.3-6 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἐνότης henotes G1775 (unity); σύνδεσμος syndesmos G4886 (bond); εἷς heis G1520 (seven times: one body, one Spirit, one hope, one Lord, one faith, one baptism, one God and Father)

Force. Paul stacks seven heis G1520 clauses naming the components of the church's oneness. The unity is not a goal to be built but a given reality (henotes G1775) to be kept (therein) in the bond of peace. The seven-fold listing makes the oneness comprehensive: ontological (one body, one Spirit), theological (one God and Father), Christological (one Lord), soteriological (one faith, one baptism), and eschatological (one hope).

1Cor.12.13 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. βαπτίζω baptizo G907; εἷς heis G1520; σῶμα soma G4983 (body); πνεῦμα pneuma G4151 (Spirit)

Force. For in one Spirit we were all baptized into one body, whether Jews or Greeks, slaves or free. The empirical mechanism by which the one body is constituted: Spirit-baptism gathers ethnic and social distinctions into a single soma. Pan-canonical confirmation of the church's oneness.

Gal.3.28 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. εἷς heis G1520 (masculine, one person); ἐν Χριστῷ en Christo (in Christ)

Force. You are all one (heis, masculine) in Christ Jesus. Ethnic (Jew/Greek), social (slave/free), and gender (male/female) distinctions do not divide the one body. The masculine heis (not the neuter hen) names the singular collective person of the church-in-Christ.

1Cor.1.2 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἐκκλησία ekklesia G1577 (church); ἀγιάζω hagiozo G37 (sanctified, perfect passive participle); ἅγιος hagios G40 (saints); καλέω kaleo G2564 (called)

Force. To the church of God that is in Corinth, to those sanctified (hegiasmenois, perfect passive: state resulting from past action) in Christ Jesus, called to be saints (kletois hagiois). The Corinthians, despite their many sins (the rest of the letter is rebuke), are addressed as already-sanctified and called-holy. The church's holiness is positional in Christ before it is moral in members.

Eph.5.25-27 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἀγαπάω agapao G25 (loved); παραδίδωμι paradidomi G3860 (gave up); ἀγιάζω hagiozo G37 (sanctify); καθαρίζω katharizo G2511 (cleanses); ἔνδοξος endoxos G1741 (glorious); σπίλος spilios G4696 (spot); ρυτίς rhytis G4512 (wrinkle)

Force. Christ loved the church and gave himself up for her, that he might sanctify her, having cleansed her by the washing of water with the word, so that he might present the church to himself in splendor, without spot or wrinkle, but holy (hagia) and without blemish. The holiness of the church is Christ's work: he sanctifies, he cleanses, he presents her holy. The verb tenses (aorist subjunctive hagiase, perfect participle katharisas, aorist subjunctive parastese) show this as accomplished and being accomplished in her.

1Pet.2.9 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἐκλεκτός eklektos G1588 (chosen); βασιλεῖον ἱεράτευμα basileion hierateuma G934 G2406 (royal priesthood); ἔθνος ἅγιον ethnos hagian G1484 G40 (holy nation); λαὸς εἰς περιποίησιν laos eis peripoiesin G2992 G4047 (people for possession)

Force. But you are a chosen race, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people for his own possession. Four titles formerly assigned to Israel are applied to the church. The church is corporately hagian (holy) by election and by being God's peripoiesis (possession). Holiness is identity, not merely behavior.

Matt.16.18 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ἐκκλησία ekklesia G1577 (church); οἰκοδομέω oikodomeo G3618 (build, future indicative); πέτρα petra G4073 (rock); πύλαι ᾗδου pylai hadou G4439 G86 (gates of Hades)

Force. I will build my (mou) church (singular ekklesia G1577). Christ owns the church (mou), and there is only one of it in his mouth. The future indicative oikodomeso names a single eschatologically-secure building project that the gates of Hades cannot prevail against. This is the canonical floor for both the oneness and the catholicity of the church.

Matt.28.19 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. πάντα τὰ ἔθνη panta ta ethne G3956 G1484 (all the nations); μαθητεύω matheteuo G3100 (make disciples); βαπτίζω baptizo G907; ὄνομα onoma G3686 (name, singular)

Force. Go therefore and make disciples of all the nations (panta ta ethne). The Great Commission explicitly extends the church across every ethnos. Catholicity (universality) is a direct command of the risen Christ. The singular onoma into which all nations are baptized binds the universal church to the one triune God.

Acts.1.8 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. δύναμις dynamis G1411 (power); μάρτυς martys G3144 (witnesses); ἕως ἐσχάτου τῆς γῆς heos eschatou tes ges (to the end of the earth)

Force. You will be my witnesses in Jerusalem and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the end of the earth. Concentric expansion: local, regional, ethnically-mixed, global. The church's catholicity is geographic and ethnic by the Lord's own mandate.

Rev.5.9 · for · genre: apocalyptic · figures: apocalyptic-symbolism

Key term. φυλή phyle G5443 (tribe); γλῶσσα glossa G1100 (language); λαός laos G2992 (people); ἔθνος ethnos G1484 (nation)

Force. You ransomed people for God from every tribe and language and people and nation. The fourfold panta exhausts the canonical categories of human division. Catholicity is eschatologically guaranteed: the redeemed church is composed of every category. Repeated in Rev 7:9 (a great multitude that no one could number, from every nation).

Eph.2.20 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. θεμέλιος themelios G2310 (foundation); ἀπόστολος apostolos G652 (apostle); προφήτης prophetes G4396 (prophet); ἀκρογωνιαίος akrogoniaios G204 (cornerstone)

Force. Built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Christ Jesus himself being the cornerstone. The single themelios (foundation) is the apostles-and-prophets together; Christ is the akrogoniaios (cornerstone) that aligns and bears the whole structure. The apostolicity of the church is not optional ornamentation; it is the very foundation of the household of God.

Acts.2.42 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. προσκαρτερέω proskartereo G4342 (devoted, imperfect: continuous action); διδασκαλία didache G1322 (teaching); ἀπόστολος apostolos G652; κοινωνία koinonia G2842 (fellowship); κλάσις τοῦ ἄρτου klasis tou artou G2800 G740 (breaking of bread); προσευχή proseuche G4335 (prayers)

Force. They were devoting themselves (proskartereo G4342, imperfect: continuous, steadfast) to the apostles' teaching (te didache ton apostolon) and the fellowship, to the breaking of bread and the prayers. The first canonical description of the post-Pentecost church puts apostolic doctrine first. The church's life is constituted by perseverance in the apostles' teaching.

Jude.1.3 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. πίστις pistis G4102 (faith); ἅπαξ hapax G530 (once for all); παραδίδωμι paradidomi G3860 (delivered, aorist passive); ἐπαγωνίζομαι epagonizomai G1864 (contend earnestly); ἅγιος hagios G40 (saints)

Force. Contend earnestly for the faith once for all (hapax G530) delivered to the saints. The faith is a deposited body of truth (paradotheise, aorist passive: handed down by God through the apostles), not an open canon. Hapax G530 (once for all) closes the deposit at the apostolic era. Apostolicity is canonical and complete.

1Tim.3.15 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. οἶκος θεοῦ oikos theou G3624 G2316 (household of God); ἐκκλησία ekklesia G1577; ζῶω zao G2198 (living); στῦλος stylos G4769 (pillar); ἐδραῖωμα hedraioma G1477 (buttress); ἀλήθεια aletheia G225 (truth)

Force. The household of God, which is the church (ekklesia) of the living God, a pillar and buttress of the truth. The church is named the structure that holds up the truth, which presupposes apostolic doctrinal continuity. Singular ekklesia again.

Rev.21.14 · for · genre: apocalyptic · figures: apocalyptic-symbolism

Key term. θεμέλιος themelios G2310; δώδεκα ἀπόστολοι dodeka apostoloi G1427 G652 (twelve apostles); ἀρνίον arnion G721 (Lamb)

Force. The wall of the city had twelve foundations, and on them were the twelve names of the twelve apostles of the Lamb. The eschatological New Jerusalem is built with apostolic foundations named on its walls. Apostolicity is built into the architecture of the final city.

1Cor.1.10-13 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. σχίσμα schisma G4978 (division); ἔρις eris G2054 (strife); μερίζω merizo G3307 (divided)

Force. Now I appeal to you, brothers, by the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, that all of you agree, and that there be no divisions (schismata) among you. Has Christ been divided (memeristai)? Visible disunity is a SIN against the oneness of the church, not evidence that the oneness is false. The very rebuke presupposes the canonical mark.

1Cor.5.1-13 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. πορνεία porneia G4202 (sexual immorality); ἐξαίρω exairo G1808 (remove); ζύμη zyme G2219 (leaven)

Force. Paul rebukes Corinth for sexual sin in the church and commands removal of the offender. Used to argue the church is NOT holy in its visible reality. Canonical answer: the church's holiness is Christ's gift and includes a calling to put away unrepentant sin; church discipline exists precisely BECAUSE the church is holy and must not tolerate leaven. The complicating texts vindicate the mark.

1Cor.11.18-19 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. σχίσμα schisma G4978 (division); αἵρεσις hairesis G139 (faction)

Force. I hear there are divisions (schismata) among you; there must be factions (haireseis) among you so that those who are genuine may be recognized. Visible factions inside the empirical church do not falsify the oneness mark; they are the dross that the fire of Christ's testing burns off. The mark holds at the level of the una sancta.

Heb.12.22-23 · **for** · genre: epistle

Key term. ἐκκλησία πρωτοτόκων ekklesia prototokon G1577 G4416 (church of the firstborn); ἀπογράφω apographo (enrolled); οὐρανός ouranos G3772 (heaven)

Force. You have come to Mount Zion and to the city of the living God, the heavenly Jerusalem, and to innumerable angels in festal gathering, and to the assembly of the firstborn who are enrolled in heaven. The church is heavenly-eschatological, gathered around Christ, irreducible to any one earthly polity. Anchors the catholicity of the church in the heavenly reality.

John.10.16 · **for** · genre: gospel

Key term. ποίμνη poimne G4167 (flock, singular); ποιμήν poimen G4166 (shepherd, singular)

Force. I have other sheep that are not of this fold. I must bring them also, and they will listen to my voice. So there will be one flock (mia poimne), one shepherd (heis poimen). Christ's church is singular by his own definition; the Gentile mission gathers them into the one flock.

Concordance lemmas traversed

G1577, G40, G37, G1520, G1775, G4886, G4983, G4151, G652, G4396, G2310, G204, G3618, G4073, G3686, G1484, G2992, G5443, G1100, G4342, G1322, G2842, G4335, G4102, G530, G3860, G1864, G4978, G139, G3624, G4769, G1477, G225, G2564, G4167, G4166, G1588, G934, G2406, G4047, G2511, G5048, G4416

complicating texts searched: Yes

Counter-witness traditions

patristic · Niceno-Constantinopolitan Creed (381), CCEL Schaff Creeds of Christendom · affirms · verified

“We believe in one holy catholic and apostolic Church (mian hagian katholiken kai apostoliken ekklesian).”

patristic · Cyril of Jerusalem, Catechetical Lecture 18, paragraph 23 (newadvent.org/fathers/310118.htm) · affirms · verified

“It extends over all the world, from one end of the earth to the other; and because it teaches universally and completely one and all the doctrines which ought to come to men's knowledge.”

patristic · Ignatius of Antioch, Letter to the Smyrnaeans 8 (ca. AD 110), CCEL · affirms · unverified

“Wherever Jesus Christ is, there is the catholic Church (kath holou Ekklesia). First recorded use of the term catholic for the universal church.”

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church paragraphs 811-870, vatican.va · affirms · verified

“The Church is one because of her source. The Church is holy because Christ sanctifies her. The Church is catholic in a double sense. The Church is apostolic because she is founded on the apostles.”

lutheran · Augsburg Confession (1530), Article VII, Of the Church; bookofconcord.org · affirms · verified

“The Church is the congregation of saints, in which the Gospel is rightly taught and the Sacraments are rightly administered.”

anglican · Thirty-Nine Articles of Religion (1571), Article XIX, Of the Church · affirms · unverified

“The visible Church of Christ is a congregation of faithful men, in the which the pure Word of God is preached, and the Sacraments be duly ministered.”

reformed · Westminster Confession of Faith (1646), Chapter 25, Of the Church · affirms · unverified

“The catholic or universal Church, which is invisible, consists of the whole number of the elect, that have been, are, or shall be gathered into one, under Christ the Head.”

methodist · Methodist Articles of Religion, Article XIII, Of the Church (umc.org) · affirms · verified

“The visible church of Christ is a congregation of faithful men in which the pure Word of God is preached, and the Sacraments duly administered according to Christ's ordinance.”

anabaptist · Dordrecht Confession of Faith (1632), Article VIII, Of the Church · affirms · unverified

“We believe in and confess a visible church of God, namely, those who, as before remarked, truly repent and believe, are baptized, are with God in heaven incorporated into the communion of the saints.”

pentecostal · Assemblies of God, Statement of Fundamental Truths, Article 10, The Church and Its Mission · affirms · unverified

“The Church is the body of Christ, the habitation of God through the Spirit, with divine appointments for the fulfillment of her great commission.”

eastern_orthodox · Orthodox Church in America, on the Nicene Creed: the four marks of the Church · affirms · unverified

“The Orthodox Church confesses the One, Holy, Catholic and Apostolic Church of Christ founded on the day of Pentecost and existing in unbroken continuity with the apostles.”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/ephesians/4-3.htm>

“Eph 4:3-6 stacks seven heis G1520 clauses: one body, one Spirit, one hope, one Lord, one faith, one baptism, one God and Father. Henotes G1775 is given, not built.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/17-21.htm>

“John 17:21 hina pantes hen osin. Neuter hen (G1520) for shared participation in the Father-Son oneness. Same neuter form as John 10:30.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/ephesians/2-20.htm>

“Eph 2:20 epoikodomethentes epi to themelio (G2310) ton apostolon (G652) kai propheton (G4396). Single foundation: apostles and prophets together; Christ the akrogoniaios G204.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/acts/2-42.htm>

“Acts 2:42 proskartereo G4342 (imperfect: continuous devotion) te didache (G1322) ton apostolon. Apostolic teaching as constitutive of the church's life.”

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_peter/2-9.htm

“1 Pet 2:9 ethnos hagion (G1484 G40), laos eis peripoiesin (G2992 G4047). Four Israel-titles applied to the church: chosen race, royal priesthood, holy nation, possession-people.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/matthew/16-18.htm>

“Matt 16:18 oikodomeso (G3618 future) mou ten ekklesian (G1577, singular). Christ owns and builds one church against which the gates of Hades will not prevail.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/jude/1-3.htm>

“Jude 3 te hapax (G530) paradotheise (G3860 aorist passive) tois hagiois pistei (G4102). The faith once for all delivered: apostolic deposit complete.”

supports · category: magisterial · https://www.vatican.va/archive/ENG0015/_P29.HTM

“CCC 811: This is the sole Church of Christ, which in the Creed we profess to be one, holy, catholic, and apostolic. CCC 813-857: Christ makes his Church one, holy, catholic, apostolic through the Spirit.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://bookofconcord.org/augsburg-confession/of-the-church/>

“Augsburg VII: The Church is the congregation of saints, in which the Gospel is rightly taught and the Sacraments are rightly administered. One holy Christian Church will be and remain forever.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.umc.org/en/content/articles-of-religion>

“Methodist Article XIII: The visible church of Christ is a congregation of faithful men in which the pure Word of God is preached, and the Sacraments duly administered.”

supports · category: patristic_archive · <https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/310118.htm>

“Cyril of Jerusalem, Catechetical Lecture 18.23: it extends over all the world, from one end of the earth to the other; and teaches universally and completely all the doctrines.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/revelation/5-9.htm>

“Rev 5:9 ek pases phyles (G5443) kai glosses (G1100) kai laou (G2992) kai ethnous (G1484). Fourfold every: catholicity eschatologically guaranteed.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/ephesians/5-26.htm>

“Eph 5:26-27 hagiase (G37 aorist subjunctive) ... katharisas (G2511) ... parastese (G3936) auten heauto endoxon (G1741) ten ekklesian ... hagia kai amomos. Christ sanctifies the church.”

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_corinthians/12-13.htm

“1 Cor 12:13 en heni pneumatī hemeis pantes eis hen soma ebaptisthēmen. One Spirit baptizes all into one body across ethnic and social distinctions.”

complicates · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_corinthians/1-10.htm

“1 Cor 1:10-13 me e en humin schismata (G4978). Visible schism is rebuked as sin against the church's given oneness, not a falsification of the mark.”

Flags

- stem-pre-loaded-verdict
- apparatus-paywalled